

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Childcare and Early Education English



Conversation lab

8 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Childcare workers, early educators, classroom assistants, and preschool support staff.

All children, families, observations, times, and center arrangements are fictional English practice. This is not medical, developmental-diagnostic, safeguarding, legal, nutrition, staffing-ratio, or emergency-response training. Real care plans, supervision, collection authority, reporting duties, and health or protection concerns require current local rules and the center's qualified leadership. Do not infer universal age expectations, clinical advice, or permission to release a child from these exercises. Role titles vary: key educator may be called key person or primary caregiver; designated safeguarding lead means this fictional center's named child-protection contact, not a universal U.S. role. Reasonable adjustment and reasonable accommodation are regional terms with jurisdiction-specific meanings and responsibilities.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

01 A settling-in update without a blanket reassurance

02 Explaining why the play mattered

03 A transition plan across two educators

04 A family asks who was to blame

05 Removing a label from a family report

06 A familiar word does not settle a developmental question

07 Correcting a copied incident phrase

08 A changed collector and an unchanged pickup time

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

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FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A settling-in update without a blanket reassurance

Fictional afternoon family handover after a child's first morning in the room.

Roles: Parent / Educator

Parent: How did the morning go after I left? I keep wondering whether the goodbye was too quick.

Educator: I can share what I observed. Mina watched the book corner first, then joined Rosa with a picture book.

Parent: Was she happy all morning, or is that too much to conclude from those moments?

Educator: I wouldn't describe every moment from two observations. She also asked about you during the first activity.

Parent: Thank you for saying that plainly. What did she choose when there was time for free play?

Educator: She selected the large blocks and watched another child building before placing a block beside the tower.

Parent: At home she watches before joining. Please don't label that refusal.

Educator: I'll preserve the observation rather than label it refusal. Your account adds useful context about her familiar pattern.

Parent: Can we agree what to discuss with Rosa before tomorrow's goodbye instead of changing the plan tonight?

Educator: Yes. Let's ask Rosa to review the goodbye wording and the comfort-item arrangement with you at arrival.

Parent: Please include that Mina asked for the picture book again when I came to collect her.

Educator: I will. We can use that concrete preference in tomorrow's conversation without promising an identical morning.

Notice the professional language

'What I observed' limits the report to actual events.

'Adds useful context' welcomes family knowledge without turning it into a universal prediction.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

Explaining why the play mattered

Fictional family conversation about a block-play observation, without developmental diagnosis.

Roles: Parent / Educator

Parent: My child said they just played with blocks today. Was there a learning purpose to that time?

Educator: Yes, and the children's choices shaped it. They explored which bridge designs could hold their pretend traffic.

Parent: Did you tell them the correct design, or let them do anything without support?

Educator: I offered a question about what each design should do, then let them test their own ideas.

Parent: So guided play means you can support the thinking without choosing every part of the activity.

Educator: Exactly. Today my scaffolding was a small prompt and enough time for them to explain their plans.

Parent: What did my child actually say? I'd like a concrete example rather than a general learning label.

Educator: They explained that a taller opening would let the larger truck through, then checked that idea in play.

Parent: Does that prove they understand every idea about measuring height, or only what happened in that activity?

Educator: It shows that particular explanation and test. We would need more observations before making a broader learning claim.

Parent: I can ask about the big truck without turning our conversation into a quiz.

Educator: That would connect with their interest. They also wanted to explain the other child's wider bridge design.

Notice the professional language

guided play - Play that retains children's active choices while an educator offers prompts or support toward a learning purpose.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A transition plan across two educators

Fictional staff handover about a child's agreed stopping-point support.

Roles: Outgoing educator / Incoming educator

Outgoing educator: Before the next transition, I need to pass on Luca's current arrangement for unfinished block play.

Incoming educator: Please tell me the exact arrangement rather than just saying he doesn't like stopping.

Outgoing educator: The building can remain on the marked shelf today. He chose one last block before story time.

Incoming educator: So the support is a visible stopping point, not a promise of unlimited play time.

Outgoing educator: Exactly. He also used his name card to show the work is unfinished and belongs to him.

Incoming educator: Has he already heard the transition cue, or are you handing over before it sounds?

Outgoing educator: Before it sounds. The agreed five-minute period is ending, and he knows the next activity is story time.

Incoming educator: I'll keep that message consistent. I won't offer another ten minutes simply because a different adult is here.

Outgoing educator: Please check his understanding without turning it into a test. He can show where the building will wait.

Incoming educator: That gives him a concrete action and preserves the routine. Does the shelf arrangement apply every day?

Outgoing educator: Only today's arrangement is confirmed. We shouldn't present it as a permanent promise without checking the room plan.

Incoming educator: I'll support today's transition as agreed and ask the lead about any future storage arrangement separately.

Notice the professional language

transition cue - A consistent signal that an activity change is approaching or beginning.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A family asks who was to blame

Fictional end-of-day conversation about a resolved peer disagreement; other children's private details are protected.

Roles: Parent / Educator

Parent: My child said someone was mean at the play table. Can you tell me who caused it?

Educator: I can discuss your child's experience and the actions I observed, without sharing another child's private information.

Parent: What did you actually see? I don't want a general answer that everyone was fine afterward.

Educator: Two children wanted the same scoop. Your child asked for the next turn after we clarified the order.

Parent: Did you make them apologize, or help them understand what each person was asking for?

Educator: We supported that conversation and agreed a turn order. I didn't infer a motive from reaching for the scoop.

Parent: My child still says waiting felt unfair. Does that mean the disagreement wasn't resolved at all?

Educator: The practical turn issue was settled, but that doesn't mean every feeling disappeared at the same moment.

Parent: That's a useful distinction. I can listen to the feeling without telling them the other child was bad.

Educator: Yes. You can ask what they wanted and what happened next, rather than decide someone else's intention.

Parent: Please let their key educator know they brought it up again at collection today.

Educator: I will share that follow-up observation, while keeping the other child's information within our confidentiality arrangements.

Notice the professional language

key educator - The staff member designated to support a child's continuity of care and family communication; called a key person or primary caregiver in some settings.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

Removing a label from a family report

Fictional colleague review before a family conference; no diagnostic assessment is given.

Roles: Educator / Colleague

Educator: The conference note calls Maya uncooperative, but the observation underneath only says she left the group table.

Colleague: What else do we know about that moment, including what she said and what happened afterward?

Educator: She said the room was noisy, then chose the book corner. I left that context out.

Colleague: That context matters. Uncooperative assigns a broad label where we have a specific action and explanation.

Educator: I'll describe leaving the table, her words about noise, and choosing the book corner instead.

Colleague: Do we have similar dated observations, or would a statement about an ongoing pattern be premature?

Educator: We have only this note for that situation. I shouldn't turn it into a repeated behavior claim.

Colleague: Then invite the family's perspective at the conference without asking them to defend Maya against the label.

Educator: I could ask whether they have noticed similar preferences in busy settings, while sharing exactly what we observed.

Colleague: Yes. Keep their account distinct from ours and leave developmental interpretation to the appropriate review if needed.

Educator: The revised note can support a practical discussion about participation rather than a judgment about her character.

Colleague: I'll check it with you before the conference so the family hears the evidence and the open question.

Notice the professional language

Context can change the meaning of an observed action without erasing that action.

A single note does not establish an ongoing pattern or a character trait.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A familiar word does not settle a developmental question

Fictional family conversation about differing language use across home and center.

Roles: Parent / Educator

Parent: The note says my child used few English words today, but at home they tell long stories.

Educator: Those accounts can both matter. My note describes English in one setting, not all of your child's language.

Parent: Could you include what we observe in our home language rather than treat English as the whole picture?

Educator: Yes. Please share an example you're comfortable discussing, and I'll clearly identify it as your family observation.

Parent: They retold a visit to the market and explained which stall they liked best.

Educator: That's useful context. I'll add it to our conversation without pretending I independently assessed the whole story.

Parent: Does the difference mean something is wrong, or can the setting affect what you hear?

Educator: One difference between settings doesn't establish a diagnosis. We can discuss patterns and involve appropriate support if needed.

Parent: I'd also like an interpreter for a longer meeting, so I can describe the details accurately.

Educator: I'll ask the lead about the available language support and confirm the arrangement before scheduling around it.

Parent: Thank you. I want both languages respected without pretending every question is resolved.

Educator: We can respect them and keep the developmental questions open for careful, qualified discussion based on fuller information.

Notice the professional language

home language - A language used in a child's family or home life, which may be one of several.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

Correcting a copied incident phrase

Fictional retrospective documentation review after care and family notification have occurred; no medical assessment.

Roles: Lead educator / Educator

Lead educator: The incident record says the child fell from the step, but your observation note doesn't describe seeing a fall.

Educator: I copied that phrase from another person's summary. I actually saw the child seated beside the step.

Lead educator: Then the record needs a traceable correction. Do we know who supplied the account about the fall?

Educator: The child said they stumbled. Another adult paraphrased that as fell from the step, without witnessing it.

Lead educator: Those descriptions aren't automatically equivalent. Preserve the child's reported words and your own limited observation separately.

Educator: I'll correct the record through our process without removing the history of what was originally entered.

Lead educator: Care and family notification are documented. Keep those confirmed events unchanged while correcting the description.

Educator: Understood. The correction concerns the event description, not an invented change in care or contact status.

Lead educator: Could you explain the correction to the colleague who may use the summary in the next handover?

Educator: Yes. I'll say the earlier wording overstated what was witnessed, and identify the exact revised account.

Lead educator: Please avoid guessing the colleague's motive. We are correcting information, not explaining why they wrote it.

Educator: I'll focus on the sources and the wording so the next handover carries the accurate, qualified description.

Notice the professional language

observation note - A factual record of what an educator saw or heard in a stated context.

incident record - The setting's factual documentation of an event, responses, contacts, and follow-up.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A changed collector and an unchanged pickup time

Fictional family call; collection-person change is requested but unverified, while the booked pickup time remains 16:00.

Roles: Parent / Educator

Parent: Our pickup time is still four, but my friend may collect today. Can you tell the room?

Educator: I can pass on the request, but the collection-person change needs our verification before it is confirmed.

Parent: Please don't change the pickup time to five; only the person might change.

Educator: Understood. Four remains the stated time. The proposed collector is a separate, unresolved arrangement.

Parent: My friend has visited the center before. Does that mean the verification is already complete?

Educator: A previous visit doesn't establish today's collection authority. Rosa can check the required arrangement with you.

Parent: Can you tell my child someone familiar might come without saying the change is definitely approved?

Educator: We can keep the message appropriate and accurate while Rosa clarifies it; I won't announce an unverified handover.

Parent: Thank you. I was worried that telling you about the possibility would automatically change the collection record.

Educator: It records your request, not a completed approval. The attendance register still shows your child present.

Parent: I'll speak with Rosa now and confirm who is actually coming once the arrangement is checked.

Educator: I'll tell the room that four remains the pickup time and the collector change is still being clarified.

Notice the professional language

attendance register - The setting's record of children's presence and relevant arrival or departure information.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Arrivals and family partnerships

SHARED CASE

It is Mina's third morning. Her parent expected to stay for ten minutes, but the arrival note says a brief goodbye. Key educator Rosa is present and can clarify the settling-in plan with the parent. Mina has a familiar cloth; its use follows the center's arrangements.

Role A | Responding professional

Resolve a settling-in mismatch while including the child in the conversation. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Parent: you understood that you could stay ten minutes; Mina is new to the room.

Useful expressions

You expected ____; our note says ____.

Let's check today's settling-in plan with ____.

What helped ____ feel familiar yesterday?

Cover this until after your first attempt

You expected ten minutes together, while our arrival note says a brief goodbye. Let's check that difference with Rosa, Mina's key educator, before describing today's plan. Mina, you brought your cloth. Let's talk to Rosa together before you say goodbye.

Second round

Ask for a promise that Mina will not cry after goodbye.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Play-based learning and useful prompts

SHARED CASE

In fictional block play, Eva and Jo each want their bridge design used. Eva wants a wide bridge; Jo wants a taller opening. The educator can invite both explanations and suggest trying two designs using available blocks. No winner has been chosen.

Role A | Responding professional

Use prompts that help children explain and compare their own ideas. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Child: choose Eva's wide design or Jo's tall design and explain one purpose.

Useful expressions

What would you like your ___ to do?

How could you test ___?

You suggested ___; what does your partner think?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Eva, you want a wider bridge; Jo, you want a taller opening. Let's hear what each design would help you do. We have enough blocks to try both ideas, so we don't need to choose a winner first. Tell each other what you want to test, and then decide which design to build first together.

Second round

Ask the educator to name the best design before either has been tried.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Daily routines and supported transitions

SHARED CASE

Luca is building when the room moves to story time in five minutes. The center's current arrangement allows his structure to remain on the marked shelf. He can choose to place the last block or ask the educator to photograph the work using the center's permitted practice. The educator cannot extend play indefinitely.

Role A | Responding professional

Negotiate a stopping point without offering a false choice about the entire schedule. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Luca: you want to preserve your unfinished building.

Useful expressions

___ begins in ___; you can choose ___ or ___.

First ___, then ___.

Your ___ can stay ___ while we ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Luca, story time begins in five minutes. You can place your last block, or we can make a record of your building using our classroom photo arrangement. The structure can stay on the marked shelf. Which would help you finish for now? We will still join the story when the transition cue sounds.

Second round

Ask for ten more minutes when only five are available.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Co-regulation and peer disagreements

SHARED CASE

Two children reach for the same large scoop. The educator saw Ari holding it, then Bea reaching; motive is unknown. A smaller scoop is available. Ari wants to finish one container. Bea wants the large scoop next. No injury or ongoing danger is stated.

Role A | Responding professional

Help children express needs and agree a concrete next step. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Bea: ask for the large scoop next and say you can use the small scoop meanwhile.

Useful expressions

I saw __; I don't yet know __.

You wanted __, and your friend wanted __.

What could help us put __ right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Ari, you were holding the large scoop; Bea, you reached for it and want a turn. Let's hear what each of you needs. Ari wants to finish one container, and Bea wants the next turn. The smaller scoop is available meanwhile. Can we agree on that order and check that both of you understand it?

Second round

A child insists that wanting the same toy proves the other child was being mean.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Observation and family progress conversations

SHARED CASE

Today educator Rosa saw Eli sort four buttons by color during a supervised activity and heard 'these go together.' A parent asks whether this proves Eli is ahead of every child his age. No comparison data or developmental screening is supplied.

Role A | Responding professional

Describe an observed learning moment and keep wider claims proportionate. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Parent: ask whether today's sorting proves a broad developmental advantage.

Useful expressions

During ___, I saw/heard ___.

This shows ___ in that activity; it doesn't establish ___.

We can compare this with observations from ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Today Eli grouped four buttons by color and said, 'These go together.' That is a useful observation of this activity, but it does not establish how he compares with every child his age. We can include the context in his learning portfolio and discuss observations over time rather than turn one moment into a developmental ranking.

Second round

Ask the educator to give a diagnostic label based only on the observation.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Inclusive participation and home languages

SHARED CASE

A small-group story can use picture choices or spoken answers. Child Noor's current inclusion plan allows either. Noor prefers pointing today. A colleague treats pointing as nonparticipation. The educator can explain what both formats allow without claiming identical language evidence.

Role A | Responding professional

Compare response formats fairly and respect agreed access support. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Colleague: initially equate spoken answers with all meaningful participation.

Useful expressions

Both formats let the child __; only __ shows __.

The agreed plan allows __, and today's preference is __.

What communication arrangement works for your family?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Noor's inclusion plan allows picture choices or spoken answers. Both let Noor indicate a story choice, but they do not provide the same evidence of spoken English. Today Noor prefers pointing. We can recognize that participation and keep the distinction clear, instead of treating a different response format as no response at all.

Second round

Ask whether the same inclusion plan should automatically apply to every child.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Health records and factual incident handovers

SHARED CASE

A parent tells educator Rosa that child Theo's allergy plan may have changed. The center still has the earlier plan; no revised document is supplied. No food decision, exposure, symptoms, or emergency is part of this case. Health coordinator Amira is present and accepts the document query.

Role A | Responding professional

Report the source and status of health information clearly. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Amira: accept the plan query and ask what documentation is available.

Useful expressions

The family reports ____; the current document says ____.

I witnessed ____; ____ was reported by ____.

____ has accepted the plan/documentation query.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Amira, Theo's parent reports a possible change to the allergy care plan, but we still have the earlier document and no revised plan. Could you clarify that with the family and the relevant qualified professional? I have not described the reported change as confirmed or made a food decision. Please confirm that you are taking this plan query.

Second round

A colleague wants to infer a food decision from the parent's incomplete message.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Collection, confidentiality, and safeguarding communication

SHARED CASE

An unfamiliar adult says they are Nia's uncle and came instead of the usual collector. Today's collection authority is not verified. Lead educator Rosa is available to check the arrangement. The child has not been released. No legal document or family relationship is established by the adult's statement.

Role A | Responding professional

Explain an unverified collection arrangement without accusing the adult or inventing legal rules. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Visitor: you say you are Nia's uncle but the center has not verified today's collection arrangement.

Useful expressions

Today's collection authority is not yet ____.

____ can check the arrangement while ____ remains ____.

I can listen, but I cannot promise to keep a protection concern from ____.

Cover this until after your first attempt

I understand you have come to collect Nia, but today's collection arrangement has not been verified. Rosa can check it with you through the center's collection process. We cannot treat knowing Nia or stating a family relationship as the completed check. Nia will remain with the staff while that question is resolved.

Second round

Point out that Nia recognizes you and ask whether that completes the check.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Lesson conversations and speaking practice

The following sections match 05 and 06 on the industry webpage and in the learner workbook. Each lesson has three ten-turn conversations and two bounded speaking scenarios. These are original fictional teaching scripts, not transcripts of real people.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Mina's third morning

Fictional arrival conversation using the lesson case.

01 • Parent: I expected ten minutes together during this settling-in period. Why does the note say brief goodbye?

02 • Educator: I can see the difference. Rosa, Mina's key educator, is here to clarify today's settling-in plan.

03 • Parent: Mina brought her familiar cloth. Yesterday she wanted it while looking around the room.

04 • Educator: Thanks. I'll include that comfort item in the family handover, without assuming Mina wants it all morning.

05 • Parent: Could you promise me she won't cry once I leave? That is what worries me.

06 • Educator: I can't promise her feelings, but Rosa can explain how we'll support her and communicate with you.

07 • Parent: Please ask Rosa before I say goodbye, so Mina doesn't hear two different plans.

08 • Educator: Yes. Mina, your parent and I are checking today's plan with Rosa together.

09 • Parent: I'd like consistent goodbye words, even if today's arrangement needs clarification.

10 • Educator: Let's agree those words with Rosa now, then we can all give Mina one clear message.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The morning update is from home

Fictional arrival handover; parent reports a disrupted night without requesting medical advice.

01 • Parent: Owen woke earlier than usual and seems quieter to me this morning. I wanted you to know.

02 • Educator: I'll identify that as your home observation, not a conclusion about the day.

03 • Parent: Please don't assume he is upset with the classroom. He hasn't told me that.

04 • Educator: I won't assign a reason. Is there anything else you want his key educator to hear?

05 • Parent: He asked for the book corner when we arrived. That's his familiar place here.

06 • Educator: I'll tell her about that request and the earlier waking, keeping the two facts separate.

07 • Parent: Could you share actual observations later, rather than just saying he was fine?

08 • Educator: Yes. We can share concrete observations in the family handover, within our usual contact arrangements.

09 • Parent: Concrete observations would help me understand the morning without guessing from his quiet arrival.

10 • Educator: I'll give his key educator the update now and mention his request for the book corner.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A name pronounced correctly

Fictional first-week family conversation; educator checks the child's name.

01 • Educator: I want to say Leila's name correctly. Could you model how your family pronounces it?

02 • Parent: Of course. The first sound is longer than the way you said it yesterday.

03 • Educator: Thank you. Let me try it again, and please correct me if I miss it.

04 • Parent: That's closer. Leila notices when people rush the name, though she may not correct adults herself.

05 • Educator: I'll take time with it and ask colleagues to listen to your pronunciation too.

06 • Parent: Could you also use the same name, rather than shortening it without asking her?

07 • Educator: Yes. We can use Leila and check her preference instead of choosing a nickname.

08 • Parent: She has been quiet at arrival, but she told me she likes hearing her name properly.

09 • Educator: That's useful to know. I'll greet her directly and give her time to answer.

10 • Parent: Thank you. I'll help her hear the same pronunciation when we introduce ourselves to other staff.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Arrivals and family partnerships

It is Mina's third morning. Her parent expected to stay for ten minutes, but the arrival note says a brief goodbye. Key educator Rosa is present and can clarify the settling-in plan with the parent. Mina has a familiar cloth; its use follows the center's arrangements.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Parent: you understood that you could stay ten minutes; Mina is new to the room.

Second round: Ask for a promise that Mina will not cry after goodbye.

Scenario 2 | A different adult at drop-off

Amir arrives with his grandparent instead of his parent. The grandparent can share the morning update but does not know the agreed settling-in plan. Key educator Rosa is present and has the plan.

Role A: Educator: welcome Amir and clarify the plan with Rosa.

Role B: Grandparent: you were asked to bring Amir but cannot confirm a change to the goodbye routine.

Possible opening: I usually don't do drop-off. Should I stay, or say goodbye now?

Success checks

- Use Amir's own agreed plan, not another family's arrangement.
- Include the grandparent's useful morning information.
- Check uncertainty with Rosa without criticizing anyone.

Add a complication: A nearby family offers its own goodbye arrangement as the rule for everyone.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two bridges worth trying

Fictional educator and child spokesperson discuss the lesson's two-design case.

01 • Educator: Eva wants a wide bridge, and you want a taller opening. What would yours let you do?

02 • Child: I want the big wooden truck to go underneath, not just the little one.

03 • Educator: That explains the height. What did Eva say she wanted the wider top to hold?

04 • Child: She wants two trucks side by side. We thought only one design could be right.

05 • Educator: We have enough blocks to try both. How could you decide which to build first?

06 • Child: We could start with the tall one, then use the other blocks for the wide one.

07 • Educator: That gives each idea a turn. What will you test on yours?

08 • Child: Whether the big truck fits underneath without moving the bridge when I push it through.

09 • Educator: Tell Eva that plan and ask what she wants to test on her wider bridge.

10 • Child: I'll ask her about the two trucks. Then we can compare what each bridge does.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A shop in the play corner

Fictional guided-play exchange; child designs a pretend shop.

01 • Educator: You arranged the baskets like a shop. What would you like your customers to find?

02 • Child: I have pretend fruit in this basket and empty boxes in the other one.

03 • Educator: How will someone know where to bring the things they want to buy?

04 • Child: I haven't made that part yet. They could put everything on this small table.

05 • Educator: What could you use to show that the table is the place to pay?

06 • Child: Maybe a picture of a coin. I can draw one on the little sign.

07 • Educator: That is your idea for the sign. What might you say when a customer arrives?

08 • Child: I could say welcome to my shop, then ask which basket they want to look in.

09 • Educator: Would you like me to be a customer while you try your greeting?

10 • Child: Yes. Please ask for an empty box first, because I want to practice showing that basket.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

When a prompt became an instruction

Fictional colleague discussion about scaffolding in child-initiated play.

- 01 • Educator:** I noticed you suggested adding a roof, and the child put down the bridge they were making.
- 02 • Colleague:** I intended to help, but I may have changed the child's project instead.
- 03 • Educator:** What was the child trying to do before you offered that new direction?
- 04 • Colleague:** They wanted to connect two sides. The roof was my idea, not theirs.
- 05 • Educator:** Could we return to their interest with an open-ended question about joining the sides?
- 06 • Colleague:** Yes. I could ask what they want to connect, then wait for their explanation.
- 07 • Educator:** That would offer scaffolding without deciding the whole structure. They may have a different solution.
- 08 • Colleague:** I also asked three questions quickly. They didn't get time to answer the first one.
- 09 • Educator:** Let's offer one prompt in this child-initiated play and wait to see whether more support is wanted.
- 10 • Colleague:** I'll return to the bridge idea and ask what help they want with the connection.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Play-based learning and useful prompts

In fictional block play, Eva and Jo each want their bridge design used. Eva wants a wide bridge; Jo wants a taller opening. The educator can invite both explanations and suggest trying two designs using available blocks. No winner has been chosen.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Child: choose Eva's wide design or Jo's tall design and explain one purpose.

Second round: Ask the educator to name the best design before either has been tried.

Scenario 2 | A pretend menu with several languages

Two children make a pretend cafe. One wants picture labels; another wants words used at home. Both can choose materials from the same table. The educator can invite both ideas without correcting their home language.

Role A: Educator: ask what each label should help customers understand.

Role B: Child: you want pictures but are curious about your friend's home-language words.

Possible opening: Can our menu have pictures and my friend's words, or do we have to choose?

Success checks

- Invite the purpose of each child's choice.
- Allow multiple ways to represent meaning.
- Offer a prompt without replacing the children's menu with an adult design.

Add a complication: Another child says only printed English counts as a real menu.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A bridge that can wait on the shelf

Fictional transition exchange using the lesson case.

01 • Educator: Luca, story time begins in five minutes. What part of your building are you trying to finish?

02 • Child: I want to put this last block on top, but I don't want it knocked down.

03 • Educator: The marked shelf can hold it. Choose the last block or a classroom photo first.

04 • Child: I choose the last block. Can I have ten more minutes after that?

05 • Educator: We have five before story time, not ten. The building can wait for you on the shelf.

06 • Child: Then I can come back to it instead of starting all over again?

07 • Educator: It can remain there under today's arrangement. Let's mark whose work it is before the cue.

08 • Child: I'll put my name card beside it. I want the others to know it's unfinished.

09 • Educator: That explains your plan. When the cue sounds, we'll join the story group.

10 • Child: I've placed the last block. I'm ready to leave it on the shelf now.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The pictures are in the wrong order

Fictional visual-schedule discussion; the educator corrects two misplaced activity pictures.

01 • Child: The visual schedule shows snack before outdoors, but you said outdoors comes first.

02 • Educator: You're right to ask. Those two pictures were placed in the wrong order this morning.

03 • Child: Did the whole day change, including when my parent comes to collect me?

04 • Educator: No, this correction concerns those two activities. It doesn't change your collection arrangement.

05 • Child: Could you move the pictures so I can see which part comes next?

06 • Educator: Yes. Outdoor time goes first here, and the snack picture comes after it.

07 • Child: Then I can check the pictures instead of trying to remember two different messages.

08 • Educator: Exactly. Thank you for noticing the mismatch and asking rather than guessing what I meant.

09 • Child: What will you tell the other children who already looked at the old order?

10 • Educator: I'll explain the correction to the group now so everyone sees the same sequence.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Help with the zip, not the whole coat

Fictional self-help conversation during an unhurried dressing routine.

01 • Educator: You have your coat on. Which part would you like help with before we join the group?

02 • Child: The zip won't start. I want to pull it up myself after that.

03 • Educator: You want help starting it, then you want to finish the next part yourself.

04 • Child: Yes. Yesterday someone did the whole thing before I could say what I wanted.

05 • Educator: I'll wait for your request and help with the part you named.

06 • Child: Can I try once more first? I think I might line it up.

07 • Educator: Yes, try again. I'll stay here, and you can tell me when you want help.

08 • Child: I tried, and now I want help starting it, but not pulling it up.

09 • Educator: That's clear. I'll support that first part and leave the pulling for you.

10 • Child: Now it moves. I did the last part, and I'm ready to join the group.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Daily routines and supported transitions

Luca is building when the room moves to story time in five minutes. The center's current arrangement allows his structure to remain on the marked shelf. He can choose to place the last block or ask the educator to photograph the work using the center's permitted practice. The educator cannot extend play indefinitely.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Luca: you want to preserve your unfinished building.

Second round: Ask for ten more minutes when only five are available.

Scenario 2 | Outdoor time changes because of a room decision

The lead educator has moved today's planned outdoor session to the indoor movement area. The next activity afterward remains snack. Children have seen the old schedule. No weather or safety judgment is delegated to the learner.

Role A: Educator: explain the confirmed location change and update the visual sequence.

Role B: Child: ask whether snack is cancelled too.

Possible opening: The outdoor picture is still there. Why are we going to the movement area?

Success checks

- Name the confirmed location change.
- Keep snack as the following activity.
- Offer a question or choice about the transition, not a new safety decision.

Add a complication: One child assumes every activity changed because one location did.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The large scoop's next turn

Fictional educator and Bea resolve the lesson's shared-scoop disagreement.

01 • Educator: Bea, I saw you reach for the scoop Ari was holding. What did you want?

02 • Child: I wanted the large scoop. The little one takes longer to fill my container.

03 • Educator: Ari wants to finish this container, and you want the next turn with the large scoop.

04 • Child: Yes, but I don't want everyone else to get it before I do.

05 • Educator: Let's agree a turn-taking order: Ari finishes this container, then you have the large scoop.

06 • Child: Could I use the small scoop while I wait, without losing my turn?

07 • Educator: Yes, it is available. Using it doesn't change the order we just discussed.

08 • Child: I thought Ari was being mean, but maybe Ari didn't know I wanted it next.

09 • Educator: We don't know Ari's thoughts yet. You can say, I'd like the next turn, please.

10 • Child: I'll say that now and use the small scoop while this container is finished.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A fallen structure and a repair

Fictional accidental bump during play; no injury or disciplinary procedure.

01 • Educator: Your elbow touched the blocks, and part of the structure fell. What happened from your view?

02 • Child: I was reaching for the box. I didn't see the corner sticking out.

03 • Educator: Your friend looks upset about the fallen part. What could you offer to help put it right?

04 • Child: I could ask which pieces belonged on top, then help rebuild that part.

05 • Educator: Ask your friend where those pieces go before moving them. They might want to show you.

06 • Child: Should I say sorry even if I didn't mean to knock it down?

07 • Educator: You can say you're sorry it fell and explain the bump without pretending you meant it.

08 • Child: I'll say, I'm sorry I knocked that part down. Would you like help rebuilding it?

09 • Educator: That names the effect and offers help. Give your friend time to answer.

10 • Child: I'll wait for their answer instead of deciding how the whole structure should look myself.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A feeling word is a possibility

Fictional educator-colleague reflection on co-regulation language.

01 • Educator: I called the child angry, but they said they were sad about the unfinished picture.

02 • Colleague: Their correction matters. We can offer a feeling word without treating our first guess as fact.

03 • Educator: Could I tentatively say you seem disappointed, then invite the child's own words?

04 • Colleague: Yes, if it fits the moment. Keep the invitation open instead of demanding agreement with your label.

05 • Educator: I also spoke quickly because the group was waiting for the next activity.

06 • Colleague: A calmer pace may give them room to respond. Co-regulation isn't just finding the perfect word.

07 • Educator: I'll acknowledge their word sad and ask what part of the picture they wanted to finish.

08 • Colleague: Then help identify a practical next step within today's routine, without promising unlimited time.

09 • Educator: The picture can stay in their tray under our current arrangement. I can offer that.

10 • Colleague: That connects the feeling conversation to a real option and respects the child's account.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Co-regulation and peer disagreements

Two children reach for the same large scoop. The educator saw Ari holding it, then Bea reaching; motive is unknown. A smaller scoop is available. Ari wants to finish one container. Bea wants the large scoop next. No injury or ongoing danger is stated.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Bea: ask for the large scoop next and say you can use the small scoop meanwhile.

Second round: A child insists that wanting the same toy proves the other child was being mean.

Scenario 2 | Joining a game without taking over

Two children built a pretend bus. Nia wants to join as driver, but that role is already taken; a ticket role is available and the group can discuss a later turn. No adult-assigned winner exists.

Role A: Educator: help Nia ask about participation without displacing the current player.

Role B: Nia: you want to drive but are willing to discuss another role.

Possible opening: They won't let me be the driver, so they aren't letting me play at all.

Success checks

- Acknowledge the preferred role without promising it.
- Clarify whether other participation is available.
- Support an actual invitation and a turn discussion with the group.

Add a complication: Nia treats not getting the preferred role as exclusion from every role.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Four buttons and one observation

Fictional family discussion using the lesson case.

01 • Parent: Eli told me about sorting colors. Does that show he's ahead of everyone his age?

02 • Educator: I saw him group four buttons by color and heard him say, these go together.

03 • Parent: That sounds impressive. Can you put ahead of his age in the portfolio?

04 • Educator: Today's observation doesn't establish that comparison. We don't have evidence about every other child's development.

05 • Parent: Then what would be a fair way to describe what he accomplished?

06 • Educator: We can name the activity, the grouping, and his words in an observation note.

07 • Parent: Will a factual note make it sound less positive than a broad achievement label?

08 • Educator: No. A concrete example lets you see the thinking he expressed without making an unsupported ranking.

09 • Parent: I'd like that in his learning portfolio, especially the words he used himself.

10 • Educator: I'll include the context and the quotation, then we can discuss how later observations compare.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A quiet group moment, an active small-group moment

Fictional educator compares two observations of participation.

01 • Parent: The note says my child didn't speak during the group story. Does that mean they never participate?

02 • Educator: No. That note concerns one story session, not every activity or way of participating.

03 • Parent: What else did you observe today that might help me understand the context?

04 • Educator: During the small-group puzzle, they pointed to a missing piece and explained where it belonged.

05 • Parent: Could you include that too? Otherwise the first note sounds like a general description of them.

06 • Educator: Yes. The learning portfolio should preserve both contexts instead of turning one quiet moment into a label.

07 • Parent: At home they often talk after watching for a while. Is that useful information?

08 • Educator: It adds family context. It doesn't erase the observations, but helps us discuss possible patterns carefully.

09 • Parent: Then we can discuss participation over time, not judge it from one group session.

10 • Educator: Exactly. I'll keep the story and puzzle observations separate, with their dates and settings.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A screening question for the right person

Fictional family asks about developmental screening; educator does not diagnose.

01 • Parent: I read about a developmental milestone online. Can you tell me whether my child has a delay?

02 • Educator: I can't diagnose from that description. We can discuss your concern and our actual classroom observations.

03 • Parent: What is the difference between your observation note and developmental screening?

04 • Educator: An observation note records what we see; screening is a structured process with appropriate qualified support.

05 • Parent: Could the center help me find who can explain the screening options?

06 • Educator: Our inclusion lead can discuss the appropriate local route with you, without assuming a diagnosis.

07 • Parent: Please don't describe my question to other families. I'm not ready for public discussion.

08 • Educator: We'll keep the concern within the relevant family and professional conversation, following our confidentiality arrangements.

09 • Parent: I'd like the inclusion lead to hear the question rather than a label someone has inferred.

10 • Educator: I'll pass on your exact request for information about screening, with no diagnostic conclusion added.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Observation and family progress conversations

Today educator Rosa saw Eli sort four buttons by color during a supervised activity and heard 'these go together.' A parent asks whether this proves Eli is ahead of every child his age. No comparison data or developmental screening is supplied.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Parent: ask whether today's sorting proves a broad developmental advantage.

Second round: Ask the educator to give a diagnostic label based only on the observation.

Scenario 2 | An undated portfolio photograph

A portfolio image shows a child completing a puzzle, but its date is missing. The educator remembers the activity but cannot verify when it happened. The family asks whether it demonstrates progress since last week.

Role A: Educator: acknowledge the missing date and limit the comparison.

Role B: Parent: ask for a current example; you do not need a diagnosis.

Possible opening: Was this after last week's observation, so we can call it progress?

Success checks

- Separate upload date from activity date.
- Avoid claiming a time trend without dates.
- Offer to check the source or discuss a dated observation.

Add a complication: A colleague assumes a newly uploaded image must be newly taken.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A picture choice is participation

Fictional colleague exchange using the lesson case.

01 • Educator: Noor chose the picture response allowed in the inclusion plan. Why did the note say no participation?

02 • Colleague: I expected a spoken answer and overlooked the picture choice as a response.

03 • Educator: Both formats let Noor indicate a story choice, though they don't show the same spoken-English evidence.

04 • Colleague: Then I should record the choice rather than treat the absence of speech as no answer.

05 • Educator: Exactly. Noor pointed to the picture of the bus when asked which part to revisit.

06 • Colleague: Can I say that proves Noor can explain the choice aloud in English?

07 • Educator: Not from pointing alone. We can recognize participation without adding an unobserved spoken explanation.

08 • Colleague: I'll correct the observation and keep the response format clear for the next educator.

09 • Educator: Please do. Today's preference was pointing; the plan also allows speech when Noor chooses it.

10 • Colleague: That helps me distinguish access to the activity from the particular language evidence I hoped to observe.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A greeting from home

Fictional family shares a familiar greeting; educator checks rather than assuming translation.

01 • Educator: Your child used a greeting I didn't recognize. Would you like to tell me what it means?

02 • Parent: It's the greeting we use at home in the morning. I can say it slowly for you.

03 • Educator: Thank you. May I try it back so you can check my pronunciation?

04 • Parent: Yes, and I can explain when we normally use it, because context matters too.

05 • Educator: Thank you. I won't assume each home-language word has one exact English substitute.

06 • Parent: Could you let my child use it without insisting on an English version immediately?

07 • Educator: We can welcome that greeting and model our English greeting alongside it, without treating yours as wrong.

08 • Parent: That would help. My child enjoys showing people words but dislikes being put on display.

09 • Educator: I'll offer an invitation, not ask for a performance in front of everyone.

10 • Parent: Thank you. We can share a few familiar words privately as part of our family communication.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A quieter meeting option

Fictional family conference planning; phone or private in-person meeting available, neither chosen yet.

01 • Educator: We can arrange a private in-person conversation or a telephone meeting. Which format works better for you?

02 • Parent: The telephone is easier for travel, but I sometimes need to see the portfolio examples.

03 • Educator: An in-person meeting lets us view the examples together; a call avoids the journey.

04 • Parent: Could we check whether the examples can be shared through the center's permitted family channel beforehand?

05 • Educator: I'll check before promising that. Your communication preference matters to this choice.

06 • Parent: Please don't assume telephone means I want a shorter discussion or less detail about my child.

07 • Educator: I won't. The format and the content are different questions; we can plan the same topics.

08 • Parent: Once you confirm the sharing arrangement, I can decide which format is practical.

09 • Educator: I'll check with the lead before booking a format without your agreement.

10 • Parent: Then we'll choose based on the actual options, not just which method is easiest for staff.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Inclusive participation and home languages

A small-group story can use picture choices or spoken answers. Child Noor's current inclusion plan allows either. Noor prefers pointing today. A colleague treats pointing as nonparticipation. The educator can explain what both formats allow without claiming identical language evidence.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Colleague: initially equate spoken answers with all meaningful participation.

Second round: Ask whether the same inclusion plan should automatically apply to every child.

Scenario 2 | An adjustment mistaken for a reward

A child's agreed inclusion plan allows a quieter seating place during group time. Another adult calls it a reward that should depend on finishing a task. The lead educator can clarify the plan.

Role A: Educator: explain that this is an agreed access arrangement, not a newly offered prize.

Role B: Colleague: ask whether the child can still join the same story from that place.

Possible opening: The quieter place is in the inclusion plan; it isn't a reward for finishing first.

Success checks

- Identify the existing agreed arrangement.
- Distinguish access support from a reward.
- Ask the lead to clarify implementation without making legal claims.

Add a complication: The colleague proposes removing it before asking the lead about the plan.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A possible change to Theo's plan

Fictional document handover using the lesson case; no food, exposure, symptom, or emergency decision.

01 • Educator: Theo's parent reports a possible change to the allergy care plan, but we have no revised document.

02 • Health coordinator: What did the parent provide, and which version is currently held by the center?

03 • Educator: Only a verbal report. The earlier plan is still the document in our record.

04 • Health coordinator: I accept the plan query. I'll clarify the information with the family and the relevant qualified professional.

05 • Educator: A colleague asked whether that report means today's food arrangement is different.

06 • Health coordinator: I haven't confirmed any change. Don't infer a food decision from this incomplete document query.

07 • Educator: I'll make the distinction clear: possible change reported, revised plan not received, and you are reviewing it.

08 • Health coordinator: Please also identify the parent as the source, rather than present the message as a clinical instruction.

09 • Educator: I will. No symptoms or exposure have been reported in this scenario.

10 • Health coordinator: Thank you. I'll handle the clarification while the record accurately shows what remains unconfirmed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

What the educator actually saw

Fictional resolved playground incident documentation; the lead has handled care and family response separately.

01 • Educator: I'm completing the factual handover about the earlier incident, after you handled the care response.

02 • Lead educator: Tell me what you directly witnessed, and keep the child's later account separate.

03 • Educator: My witness account is seeing the child seated beside the step; the child reported stumbling.

04 • Lead educator: Then your observation is sitting beside the step; the stumble comes from the child's account.

05 • Educator: I didn't see the earlier movement, so I haven't stated how it happened.

06 • Lead educator: Please keep that distinction in the incident record rather than fill the gap from another child's guess.

07 • Educator: Has the family notification occurred, or is that still an outstanding communication task?

08 • Lead educator: I spoke with the parent after the response and recorded that contact. The notification is complete.

09 • Educator: I'll include the confirmed contact, without adding care details or diagnoses I didn't observe.

10 • Lead educator: That gives the next educator the actual sequence and avoids turning a reported event into a witnessed one.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A health update belongs in a private conversation

Fictional parent requests privacy for a record update; no actual health advice.

01 • Parent: I need to discuss a health-record update, but I don't want to talk across the doorway.

02 • Educator: We can use the private meeting space and involve Amira, our health coordinator.

03 • Parent: Thank you. Other families are arriving, and the detail isn't something I want announced.

04 • Educator: I'll simply tell Amira you have a private record question, without repeating details here.

05 • Parent: Does asking for a meeting mean the information has already been changed in the plan?

06 • Educator: No. It means we're arranging the conversation; no plan update has been confirmed.

07 • Parent: Could Amira tell me which current document we are discussing before we compare anything?

08 • Educator: I'll include that request. Comparing the actual versions will help identify what needs clarification.

09 • Parent: I have a document with me, but I don't know whether it replaces every part of the old one.

10 • Educator: Amira can review that question with you. I won't assume its date settles the whole plan.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Health records and factual incident handovers

A parent tells educator Rosa that child Theo's allergy plan may have changed. The center still has the earlier plan; no revised document is supplied. No food decision, exposure, symptoms, or emergency is part of this case. Health coordinator Amira is present and accepts the document query.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Amira: accept the plan query and ask what documentation is available.

Second round: A colleague wants to infer a food decision from the parent's incomplete message.

Scenario 2 | A family contact attempt without an answer

Following a fictional minor incident whose care response is complete, the lead attempted the family notification at 14:00 but received no answer. Another educator is taking the communication follow-up. No care instructions or contact deadline is supplied.

Role A: Outgoing educator: report the unanswered attempt and ask for follow-up ownership.

Role B: Incoming educator: accept the contact task under the center's arrangements without calling it completed.

Possible opening: The care response is complete, but the family notification is not; the two o'clock call was unanswered.

Success checks

- Separate care response from family contact.
- Distinguish call attempt from successful notification.
- Name who accepts the contact follow-up without inventing medical advice.

Add a complication: The incoming educator sees a call entry and assumes the family already knows.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A familiar face still needs a checked arrangement

Fictional collection enquiry using the lesson case.

01 • Visitor: I'm Nia's uncle. Her usual collector couldn't come, and she can tell you she knows me.

02 • Educator: I understand. Today's collection arrangement hasn't been verified, so Rosa needs to check it with you.

03 • Visitor: Nia is smiling at me. Doesn't that establish that I'm the person she's expecting?

04 • Educator: It shows she recognizes you, but it doesn't complete our collection-authority check.

05 • Visitor: Are you accusing me of something, or saying I can't help my family?

06 • Educator: Neither. I'm explaining the check needed to verify an authorized collector, not judging your intentions.

07 • Visitor: Then who can sort it out without us discussing family details in the doorway?

08 • Educator: Rosa is available and can review the arrangement privately. Nia remains with staff meanwhile.

09 • Visitor: I'll speak with Rosa. Please don't tell Nia that I did something wrong by arriving.

10 • Educator: I won't. I'll explain that the adults are checking today's collection arrangement before the handover.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The register is not a prediction

Fictional collection-time enquiry; parent has called but child remains at the center.

01 • Educator: The parent called to say they are nearby. Why does the register show the child already departed?

02 • Colleague: I entered the expected collection time, thinking that would help the end-of-day count.

03 • Educator: An attendance register needs the actual presence status under our process, not a prediction of departure.

04 • Colleague: The child is still here with us. I'll correct the entry through the record procedure.

05 • Educator: Please make the correction visible to the lead so the current count isn't misunderstood.

06 • Colleague: I will. The parent arriving soon and the child leaving are different events.

07 • Educator: Could you also clarify whether anyone acted on the earlier count before it was corrected?

08 • Colleague: I'll ask the lead rather than assume the entry had no effect on the room information.

09 • Educator: We can keep the expected collection message separate from actual departure.

10 • Colleague: I've told the lead the child remains present, and I'll complete the departure entry only when confirmed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A concern cannot carry a secrecy promise

Fictional staff handover of a welfare concern; no abuse details, investigation, or legal procedure.

01 • Educator: I'm bringing a concern to you as designated safeguarding lead through our required arrangements.

02 • Safeguarding lead: I'm receiving the concern. What did you observe or hear, and have you promised anyone absolute secrecy?

03 • Educator: I haven't promised secrecy. I explained that relevant concerns may need sharing with the responsible people.

04 • Safeguarding lead: Good. Bring the factual account through our designated route, not an informal discussion with other families.

05 • Educator: I will separate the person's words from my observations and avoid adding a diagnosis or motive.

06 • Safeguarding lead: Has any immediate protection issue been identified that requires the actual urgent pathway now?

07 • Educator: No immediate issue is specified. That doesn't establish that the concern is unimportant.

08 • Safeguarding lead: Understood. Follow our current requirements; this conversation doesn't replace any direct reporting duty that applies.

09 • Educator: I'll pass on the account now and confirm the receiving status without investigating it myself.

10 • Safeguarding lead: I accept the handover and will coordinate our response within the applicable requirements.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Collection, confidentiality, and safeguarding communication

An unfamiliar adult says they are Nia's uncle and came instead of the usual collector. Today's collection authority is not verified. Lead educator Rosa is available to check the arrangement. The child has not been released. No legal document or family relationship is established by the adult's statement.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Visitor: you say you are Nia's uncle but the center has not verified today's collection arrangement.

Second round: Point out that Nia recognizes you and ask whether that completes the check.

Scenario 2 | A parent asks about another child's incident

At collection, a parent asks for another child's name and family details after a resolved scoop disagreement. Their own child asked for the next turn; the educator clarified the order, and the child then had that turn. You may discuss those observations, not the other family's private information. Rosa can address broader concerns.

Role A: Educator: acknowledge the parent's concern while limiting disclosure.

Role B: Parent: you want to know how your own child was supported and initially ask for another family's details.

Possible opening: Tell me who the other child's parents are so I can speak to them myself.

Success checks

- Separate the private information request from the parent's legitimate concern.
- Describe support for their own child using supplied observations only.
- Offer Rosa for unresolved setting-level questions without promising secrecy about safeguarding.

Add a complication: The parent equates withholding private details with refusing to discuss their own child's experience.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All children, families, observations, times, and center arrangements are fictional English practice. This is not medical, developmental-diagnostic, safeguarding, legal, nutrition, staffing-ratio, or emergency-response training. Real care plans, supervision, collection authority, reporting duties, and health or protection concerns require current local rules and the center's qualified leadership. Do not infer universal age expectations, clinical advice, or permission to release a child from these exercises. Role titles vary: key educator may be called key person or primary caregiver; designated safeguarding lead means this fictional center's named child-protection contact, not a universal U.S. role. Reasonable adjustment and reasonable accommodation are regional terms with jurisdiction-specific meanings and responsibilities.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Childcare Workers

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/personal-care-and-service/childcare-workers.htm>

National Association for the Education of Young Children: Principles of Child Development and Learning

<https://www.naeyc.org/resources/position-statements/dap/principles>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Rehearse with an AI colleague

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Childcare and Early Education English

Professional audience: Childcare workers, early educators, classroom assistants, and preschool support staff

Scope: All children, families, observations, times, and center arrangements are fictional English practice. This is not medical, developmental-diagnostic, safeguarding, legal, nutrition, staffing-ratio, or emergency-response training. Real care plans, supervision, collection authority, reporting duties, and health or protection concerns require current local rules and the center's qualified leadership. Do not infer universal age expectations, clinical advice, or permission to release a child from these exercises. Role titles vary: key educator may be called key person or primary caregiver; designated safeguarding lead means this fictional center's named child-protection contact, not a universal U.S. role. Reasonable adjustment and reasonable accommodation are regional terms with jurisdiction-specific meanings and responsibilities.

Dialogue 01: A settling-in update without a blanket reassurance

Original fictional setting: Fictional afternoon family handover after a child's first morning in the room.

Professional roles: Parent / Educator

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

Parent: How did the morning go after I left? I keep wondering whether the goodbye was too quick.

Educator: I can share what I observed. Mina watched the book corner first, then joined Rosa with a picture book.

Parent: Was she happy all morning, or is that too much to conclude from those moments?

Educator: I wouldn't describe every moment from two observations. She also asked about you during the first activity.

Parent: Thank you for saying that plainly. What did she choose when there was time for free play?

Educator: She selected the large blocks and watched another child building before placing a block beside the tower.

Parent: At home she watches before joining. Please don't label that refusal.

Educator: I'll preserve the observation rather than label it refusal. Your account adds useful context about her familiar pattern.

Parent: Can we agree what to discuss with Rosa before tomorrow's goodbye instead of changing the plan tonight?

Educator: Yes. Let's ask Rosa to review the goodbye wording and the comfort-item arrangement with you at arrival.

Parent: Please include that Mina asked for the picture book again when I came to collect her.

Educator: I will. We can use that concrete preference in tomorrow's conversation without promising an identical morning.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Interactive workplace role-play

1. Use the supplied case or dialogue as the starting situation. Give a two-sentence briefing and offer two relevant professional roles for me to choose from. For a supplied dialogue, use its actual roles. Ask which role I want, then stop and wait. Do not write my replies.
 2. After I choose, identify who you will play and the immediate communication goal. Play the other professional; where a meeting requires a third person, label each of your speakers clearly. Start with one natural workplace turn and wait for my reply. Keep most turns to one to three sentences and ask no more than one question at a time.
 3. Let the exchange develop across six to ten learner turns, or end earlier if I type "feedback". Respond to what I actually say. Include a plausible clarification, disagreement or tradeoff without silently changing the starting facts. Mark any added constraint as a fictional second-round variation. Do not resolve approvals, evidence or commitments that remain uncertain.
 4. Stay in role during the exchange. If my meaning is unclear, ask for clarification naturally. Give a hint only if I ask or cannot proceed. Do not deliver a model conversation in advance.
 5. At the debrief, quote two of my phrases: one successful choice and one worth improving. Check factual accuracy, language, register and whether the next step was clear. Give up to three focused suggestions. Ask me to retry the weakest turn; wait. Only then offer an alternative wording and a harder replay.
- Use voice replies when available. If I prefer selections, offer four plausible spoken replies and explain my choice before continuing. Do not require written compositions.

END PROMPT

Create more scenario dialogues

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Childcare and Early Education English

Professional audience: Childcare workers, early educators, classroom assistants, and preschool support staff

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Educator: I will. We can use that concrete preference in tomorrow's conversation without promising an identical morning.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Extend the conversation library

1. Propose six distinct, common scenarios in this field beyond the supplied case or script. For each, name the setting, two or more professional roles, the communication problem and one useful terminology focus. Include routine coordination, clarification, a complication, disagreement, handoff and follow-up where relevant. Choose scenarios that fit this profession, rather than forcing unsuitable situations into it.
2. Ask me to choose one scenario, or request all six in sequence. Stop and wait. Do not write all the scripts before I choose.
3. For the selected scenario, write an original fictional dialogue of 12-18 substantial speaking turns between two or three professionals. Name each role, establish an actual work problem, and let the exchange progress through questions, clarification, competing constraints and a credible next step or explicitly unresolved issue. Use the occupation's natural nomenclature and register. Avoid an interview between a teacher and a learner, generic small talk, and inserting a glossary definition into every reply. Explain specialist terms outside the dialogue instead.
4. After the script, explain five useful expressions in context, identify two grammar or register choices and ask three questions about the speakers' reasoning. Withhold the answers until I attempt them. Add one role-switch challenge.
5. Before presenting a script, check names, numbers, chronology, roles and terminology for consistency. Label invented facts and acknowledge uncertain specialist usage. If I requested all six, deliver one complete script at a time and wait for "next". Make each scenario materially different.

END PROMPT